[METRIC]
A-A-370B
July 08, 1998
SUPERSEDING
A-A-370A
November 27, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
RIBBON, PRINTING
COTTON AND NYLON RIBBONS FOR TELETYPEWRITER, TYPEWRITERS, RECORDING MACHINES AND COMPUTING MACHINES

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. **Scope:** This Commercial Item Description covers woven cotton and nylon fabric computing and recording machine ribbons.

2. **Salient Characteristics:**

2.1 **Weave.** The fabric shall have a regular commercial weave suitable for the purpose intended.

2.2. **Ribbons.** Ribbon edges shall be straight and parallel with the warp threads. To prevent fraying, edges of cotton ribbons shall be woven or treated, and edges of nylon ribbons shall be fused.

2.3 **Thickness & Yarn Count.** Ribbon thickness and yearn count shall be as specified in the contract or ordering document. ASTM D 1777 shall be used to determine thickness. Edges shall not be used to determine fabric thickness.

2.4 **Color.** Ribbons shall be single color or two color as specified. Two-color ribbons shall have an equal width for each color, unless otherwise specified.

2.5 **Inking.** Ribbons shall be evenly inked. The division of two-color ribbons shall be clearly delineated, and neither color shall bleed into the other prior to or during ribbon use.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7510

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.6 **Length.** Length shall be as specified as a minimum. Ribbons shall be furnished in continuous lengths without joining or splicing.

2.7 **Width.** Ribbon width shall be as specified. A tolerance of + 0.4 mm – 0.0 mm (+ 1/64 inch – 0.0 inch) shall be permitted, provided print quality and ribbon operation are not affected.

2.8 **Spools, Cartridges, & Cores.** Each ribbon shall be furnished on a metal or plastic spool, cartridge, fiber core, fiber center or in a coreless configuration for the specified machine. Metal, except aluminum, shall have an enamel, lacquer, or plated finish. Each ribbon shall be designed to operate satisfactorily with the ribbon feed and reversing mechanisms of the machine specified.

2.9 **Workmanship.** Ribbons and their spools, cartridges, or cores shall be free from defects that will affect performance and serviceability, or present a hazard to the user. Examples of ribbon defects are uneven weave, frayed edges, slits, and knots.

2.10 **Shelf Life.** Ribbons shall have a shelf life of one year after delivery and shall be capable of withstanding normal usage and handling.

3. **Regulatory Requirements:** The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials too the maximum extent practical, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

3.1 **Hazardous Material Requirements.**

3.1.1 **Toxicity.** Use of any toxic substance must be in accordance with all applicable federal statutes. The use of any known carcinogens as ingredients is prohibited. The harmful substances shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances as designated in Federal Standard 313. The vendor shall prepare a certification that the ribbon conforms to the above requirements.

3.1.2 **Material Safety Data Sheets.** Data sheets shall be furnished in accordance with Federal Standard 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Federal Standard 313.

3.1.3 **Labeling.** Containers shall be labeled to comply with the "Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations", 16 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 1500.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. **Quality Assurance Provisions:**

4.1 **Product Conformance.** The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description. The quality of the product sold to the government shall be equal to or better than the quality of the product sold by the manufacturer in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

4.1.1 **Performance.** When used on the designated machine model, ribbons shall produce clear, clean, and legible type impressions. There shall be no evidence of type filling. Type filling is the filling of the typeface with fibers or ink from the ribbon, resulting in gradual broadening or feathering of typed impressions. There shall be no evidence of oil staining when ribbon impressions are examined. The ribbon shall pass the performance tests and required OEM (original equipment manufacturers) specification in accordance with paragraph 4.1.2.

4.1.1.1 **Typing Quality.** The typed letters shall be sharp and easily legible, without appreciable feathering, and the page shall be clean, when tested in accordance with paragraph 4.1.2.

4.1.1.2 **Type Filling.** There shall be no evidence of filling of type when tested in accordance with paragraph 4.1.2.

4.1.1.3 **Uniformity of Inking & Density.** Ribbons shall be uniformly inked within and between rolls from the same contract, with a density tolerance for initial lines of not more than 0.2 when tested in accordance with paragraph 4.1.2.

4.1.1.4 **Weardown.** On black record ribbons the density of the 120th line shall not be less than 30% of the density of the first line when tested in accordance with section II. On black and red record ribbons the density of the 75th line shall not be less than 30% of the first line when tested in accordance with paragraph 4.1.2.

4.1.1.5 **Recovery.** The density of the recovery line shall not be less than that of line 110 for single-color ribbons and line 60 for two-color ribbons, when tested in accordance with paragraph 4.1.2.

4.1.1.6 **Oiliness.** There shall be no evidence of staining when examined in accordance with paragraph 4.1.2.

4.1.1.7 **Permanence of Typing.** The typing shall show no marked fading when tested in accordance with paragraph 4.1.2.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

4.1.2 **Performance Tests.** Type filling and uniformity of inking shall be performed in accordance with the procedures of ASTM F 497, using 10 point pica type and ASTM F 92.

4.1.2.1 Clean all type, then type 500 characters near the start of the ribbon, using all the upper- and lower-case characters. Examine for sharpness of characters and cleanliness of page.

4.1.2.2 Type 800 upper case's and examine the impressions for evidence of filling.

4.1.2.3 Type 200 upper case H's overtyped with upper case I's and X's. Determine the average reflection density from 10 readings.

(a) Repeat tests as cited in paragraphs 4.1.2.1, 4.1.2.2 and, 4.1.2.3 (c) in the middle and last thirds of ribbon. Clean the type before each series of tests.
(b) Check for proper ribbon advance and reversal where applicable.
(c) Repeat tests as cited in paragraphs 4.1.2.1 thru 4.1.2.3 on 3 more ribbons.
(d) Perform test as cited in paragraph 4.1.2.3 on the control ribbon if required.

4.1.2.4 **Weardown & Recovery Test.** Perform the following tests in accordance with procedures of ASTM F 497, using freshly cleaned 10 point pica type and a new ribbon. Use voltage regulators as recommended for the typewriters and the densitometer.

4.1.2.4.1 In this test the same position of ribbon is to be used to type 121 lines. If the ribbon cannot be reversed or rewound at the end of each line, the following procedure is to be used: Unwind approximately 1 m of ribbon and lay the spool at one side of the machine, with the end of the ribbon across the machine. By suitable means, fasten the ribbon to opposite ends of the carriage with the ribbon in contact with the paper under just enough tension to permit typing.

4.1.2.4.2 Insert a sheet of 75 g/m2 No. 7 Bond white paper. Type 120 lines of approximately 50 upper-case H's overtyped with upper-case I's and X's. For two-color ribbons type only 75 lines on each color. On lines 1, 110, 120, (1, 60, 75 for two-color ribbons) leave a space between characters; do not leave a space between characters on the other lines. On completion of the last line, allow 20 min. for recovery and then type the recovery line (the 121st for single-color and 76th for two-color), allowing a space between characters.

4.1.2.5 **Oiliness.** - Retain the test sheet described the weardown and recovery test for 24 hr then examine both sides of the sheet for evidence of oil stains around the letters.

5. Packaging:

Packaging, packing, palletization and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026l0-26T08:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

6. Notes:

6.1 Source of Documents. The following documents form a part of the commercial item description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

6.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

6.1.2 Copies of the appropriate ASTM (s) may be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials at 100 Barr Harbor Dr., West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

6.1.3 Federal Standards and Specifications may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW Washington DC 20407.

6.2 Ordering information. Purchasers shall select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(1) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
(2) Purchaser shall specify the ribbon dimensions and shall indicate length, width, color and inking criteria (if other than specified in the CID), manufacturer's name and model number of the machine on which the ribbon will be used in the procurement document. Purchasers shall indicate the original manufacturers specifications (OEM) if required.
(3) Material safety data sheets required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.3 **National Stock Number Listing (NSN's).** The following is a list of nsn's assigned which correspond to this commercial item description. The list may not be indicative of all possible nsn's associated with the (CID).

7510-00-162-3016	7510-00-274-5485	7510-00-687-8057
7510-00-162-3019	7510-00-274-5487	7510-00-820-2744
7510-00-162-3021	7510-00-274-5489	7510-00-861-1573
7510-00-162-3022	7510-00-285-3005	7510-00-881-9648
7510-00-162-3023	7510-00-285-3020	7510-00-914-1575
7510-00-164-1391	7510-00-285-3024	7510-00-925-0967
7510-00-164-1394	7510-00-285-3025	7510-00-965-2307
7510-00-197-9193	7510-00-582-4709	7510-00-982-5829
7510-00-205-2245	7510-00-584-3868	7510-01-015-3253
7510-00-249-3091	7510-00-616-9125	
7510-00-264-5962	7510-00-634-3446	

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.